bringing down cellular providers down to their knees. Call drops and data packet loss is an unavoidable consequence of spectrum congestion adding to the country's bandwidth woes. On top of this, the government has plans to open over 1 million public Wi-Fi hotspots, especially at tourist places, to promote its digital cities initiatives. All of these milestones will be left unrealised if more spectrum isn't freed up for Internet service providers.

BARRIER TO INTERNET ACCESS NEEDS TO GO

One of the biggest enablers of our times is undoubtedly the Internet, which has democratized access to information and knowledge, bringing down socio-economic, racial and cultural barriers by connecting all of humanity unlike any other phenomenon before it. Through the Internet, far-reaching impact is just a click away. But without the Internet, the promise of a bright new tomorrow vanishes into thin air just as quickly.

And the brutal reality of it all is that India still remains a vastly underpenetrated country when it comes to access to Internet. Why is that?

According to McKinsey's "Barriers to Internet Adoption" report (http://goo.gl/Qji5AE), 60 percent of the world's population still remains unaware and untouched by the Internet phenomenon – that's about four billion people. India's contribution to this global Internet illiteracy is about 25 percent. That's a huge number in itself. And the major challenges preventing people from accessing the Internet are synonymous with those affecting our country's poor – illiteracy, poverty, and lack of basic necessities.

Even by the global ICT Index, a report published by International Telecommunications Union last year, India's preparedness to propel the Digital India initiative is at an embarrassingly low level. The report rates the tech-savviness of a nation and the quality of its efforts to reduce the digital divide, besides assessing other parameters like network infrastructure and access to technology products. Not surprisingly, the report's contents paint

AKAMAIS STATE OF THE INTERNET

ASIA PACIFIC HIGHLIGHTS (Q1 2015)

INTERNET & BROADBAND ADOPTION

Across the first quarter of 2015, Akamai observed strong, positive connectivity growth. From a global perspective, the average connection speed increased 10% quarter-over-quarter (QoQ) and 30% year-over-year (YoY) to 5 Mbps, while the global average peak connection speed increased 8.2% QoQ and 37% YoY to 29.1 Mbps. In the Asia-Pacific region, South Korea had the highest average connection speed at 23.6 Mbps, while Indonesia had the lowest at 2.2 Mbps. Singapore had the highest peak connection speed at 98.5 Mbps, while India had the lowest at 17.4 Mbps

5 Mbps
Global Average Connection Speed

29.1 Mbps
Global Average Peak Connection Speed

Country/Region	Q1 2015 Avg. Mbps	Q1 2015 Peak Mbps
South Korea	23.6	79.0
Hong Kong	16.7	92.6
Japan	15.2	70.1
Singapore	12.9	98.5
Taiwan	10.5	71.5
New Zealand	8.4	36.7
Australia	7.6	40.8
Thailand	7.4	50.6
Sri Lanka	4.8	30.8
Malaysia	4.3	31.5
China	3.7	19.4
Vietnam	3.2	21.3
Philippines	2.8	20.3
India	2.3	17.4
Indonesia	2.2	17.5